Letter from Ur-saga to a king fearing the loss of his father's household -- an English prose translation

ETCSL t.3.3.01 — converted from ETCSL TEI XML (Oxford Text Archive item 2518, revised edition Oct 2006; CC BY-NC-SA 3.0).
Source file: `t.3.3.01.xml`; web: https://etcsl.orinst.ox.ac.uk/cgi-bin/etcsl.cgi?text=t.3.3.01

Paragraph labels = ETCSL composite line ranges covered by each translation paragraph. "..." = untranslatable/lost text.

1-2. Speak to my lord, the bull [note: 1 ms. has instead:] wild bull [note: 1 other ms. has instead:] bison (?) with sparkling eyes, who wears a lapis-lazuli beard:

3-5. Repeat to my golden statue born on a favourable day, to my water buffalo reared in a holy fold, chosen in the heart of holy Inana [note: 1 ms. has instead:] of holy Inana, ... of Suen , to my lord, the trusted one of Inana:

6-9. You are fashioned like the son of An. As with the words of a god, what you say is irrevocable [note: 1 ms. has instead:] all the foreign lands cannot answer (?) your words . Your words, like rain pouring from the skies, are uncountable [note: 1 ms. has instead:] are uncheckable [note: 1 other ms. has instead:] are uncontrollable (?) : this is what Ur-saga, your servant, says:

10-14. My lord has taken care of me [note: 2 mss. have instead:] has not taken care of me ; I am a citizen of Urim. If my lord agrees [note: 1 ms. has instead:] If it pleases my lord , let no one waste my father's household, let no one take away the home of my father's estate [note: 1 ms. has instead:] my old man's home ! May my lord know this!